Your 6-month plan could take 6 weeks

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📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter claims most long-term timelines are set by averaging mediocre results. By planning aggressively enough to make failure impossible, using AI to build a calendar with no white space, and picking only two goals, six months of progress can be compressed into six weeks.

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🧠 Why Long-Term Plans Underestimate What's Possible 0:00

- Long-term planning is valuable because it produces better decisions
  - Example: trying to make $1M today might require unethical shortcuts; planning for a year from now produces a safer, smarter strategy
- The problem: most people's timelines are based on **average performance**
  - Consciously or subconsciously, people benchmark how long something "should" take against what the average person achieves
  - The average American is 17 pounds overweight and has less than $1,000 in savings — a terrible benchmark
- The opportunity: it only takes a small amount of extra effort to surpass the average person at almost anything; this plan calls for a *lot* more than a small amount
- Brandon's credibility framing: grew up on the South Side of Chicago, built multi-figure businesses, 27-year career as a personal trainer, helped thousands make hundreds of thousands to millions per year as online trainers

🎯 The Core Philosophy: Plan to Make Failure Impossible 3:51

- Most people plan goals the way you'd swat a bug — you *might* hit it, you might miss
  - Shoe, fly swatter, chain plate: low-certainty tools
- The right approach: call the exterminator, fumigate the whole house
  - Bring all the poison, all the traps, everything — eliminate not just the bug but its whole family
  - Goal: make it structurally *impossible* to fail
- **Reframe the planning question:**
  - Wrong question: "How much effort do I need to put in to accomplish this goal?"
  - Right question: "What amount of effort must I put in to make failure impossible within the next six weeks?"
- Guitar teacher story illustrates the standard:
  - Brandon was hired to play guitar for a singer's show — just him and her, no band to hide behind
  - He practiced unfamiliar chord changes with his teacher until he got it right
  - Teacher's response: "Amateurs practice till they get it right. **Professionals practice till they cannot get it wrong.**"
  - That quote reframed how Brandon approaches every goal

- If you look at the plan and think "I don't want it that bad" — that's fine
  - Brandon once thought he wanted to be a doctor; when he found out how long school takes and how much debt doctors carry, he moved on without bitterness
  - Don't become a hater; just find something you *do* want badly enough

🏆 Pick Only Two Goals: Income and Fitness 7:38

- Compressing 6 months into 6 weeks requires ruthless focus — you cannot pursue many goals at once
- Suggested framework: **four quadrants of life**

Quadrant	Notes
Income / Business	Required — you need money for food, water, shelter
Health / Fitness	Required — if health goes, everything goes
Friends & Family	Additive, not survival-critical
Romantic Relationships	Additive, deserves its own category once intimacy is involved

- Only income and health are truly non-negotiable; the other two make life worth living but aren't survival requirements
- Improving the money and health quadrants *automatically* lifts the other two:
  - More money → can take family on vacations, buy mom a car, pay her bills, support a partner
  - Getting in shape → family members start asking for advice, eating better, living longer
- **Pick one goal from income and one from fitness — that's it**

🗓️ Step 1 — Block Out Non-Negotiable Responsibilities 10:40

- The only things a person *has* to do (block these first):
  - Sleep
  - Work or school
  - Family time
  - Working out
  - Everything else is optional
- Use an AI assistant connected to Google Calendar to set these as recurring blocks
  - Example prompt to Gemini: "Go into my Google Calendar and mark off the time I sleep. I go to sleep every day at 10 and wake up at 6. Mark that as a recurring task indefinitely. I work out at 7 each day, 7 days a week. I work from 9 a.m. to 5 p.m. Let me know when you're done."
  - Also block commute, date night (e.g., Friday recurring), family time, etc.
- Example output: 117 hours of a 168-hour week already accounted for → **51 hours of open time left each week to grind**
- The remaining white space is the raw material for your six-week push

🤖 Step 2 — Use AI to Build Your Aggressive Plan 13:00

- Open your LLM of choice (Claude, ChatGPT, Google Gemini, Grok — "all suitable")
  - For Gemini: use the most capable model (Argon), set to "high" reasoning
  - For Claude: use Opus 5.5
  - For ChatGPT: use Astra (or the top available model)
- Example prompt structure:
  - "I have two goals. One is to make $100,000 in my online fitness business. The other is to get to 8% body fat. Help me map out what I need to do. I don't want a plan based on what I *think* should be done — I want a plan where I put in so much effort that failure would be impossible. Ask me any follow-up questions you need."
- The AI will ask clarifying questions (current baseline, resources, schedule, etc.) — answer honestly with real data

    - Brandon notes he has his Go HighLevel CRM connected when doing this seriously, so the AI knows his actual business data
- After the plan is generated, push it further: "Fill up almost all the white space within the next 6 weeks"
- When done, your calendar should have **almost no white space** — every available hour assigned
- No-prompt-engineering required: "The models are smart enough you can just talk to them like people"

📅 Step 3 — Fill the White Space and Live by Your Calendar 15:18

- Living out of the calendar is Brandon's **#1 productivity hack**
    - He has done this since smartphones launched around 2009
    - His own calendar currently has almost no white space
- Origin story — 2009: father had died by suicide the year before, recession of '08 meant no good jobs despite having a college degree
    - Worked 4 jobs simultaneously, 12–14 hour days, 7 days a week, for **2 years**
        - 4 a.m.: trained clients in the morning
        - Showered at the gym
        - 8-hour shift as security guard at the Prada store
        - After that: worked for a moving company (5 days/week)
        - Weekends: trained clients in the morning, then managed a BBQ restaurant in Queens on Snowway Street
    - Only possible because every hour of every day was planned on the calendar
    - Still got 7–8 hours of sleep throughout
    - This grind eventually led to the idea of training people *online* — a novel concept at the time
- Side benefit of a full calendar: **bad habits disappear automatically**
    - "When you going to find OnlyFans time? When you going to find time to get high?"
    - Brandon accidentally stopped drinking and smoking — not through willpower or a declaration, just by being too busy
    - "White space is the devil. That's where the devil lives and comes to knock you off your grind."
- Treat every minute like a bullet you're shooting at your targets; use each one

⚠️ Common Pitfalls: Planning vs. Execution Failures 17:32

- Two places where the system breaks down:
    - Bad planning (you don't yet know *what* to do)
    - Poor execution (you can't yet stick to the schedule)
- **Planning failures:**
    - AI is a great starting point but won't cover everything, especially for highly ambitious goals
    - First 1–2 weeks may need to be dedicated to intense studying: buying courses, reading books, joining communities
    - **Best solution: get a mentor** — "the mentor-mentee relationship is the only form of education that never fails"
        - Books and courses don't always produce results; a good mentor sees what you can't see
        - Guitar teacher example: YouTube videos gave some progress, but progress was "lightning fast" once he had a mentor
        - Jordan needed coach Tim Grover to build his body enough to win championships
        - Jordan then mentored Kobe; Kobe went on to win five championships
        - "These are two of the greatest basketball players of all time and they still couldn't do it without mentors"
    - Brandon spends **~$100,000 per year** on his own education (courses, groups, coaches) — "it more than pays for itself each year"
- **Execution failures:**
    - Not being used to living on a schedule — expect to mess up at first, that's normal
    - Misjudging how long tasks take (overestimating or underestimating) — also normal
    - **Key rule — two types of tasks:**

Task Type	Rule
One-time tasks (e.g., open a business bank account)	Move freely if something comes up — just don't delete, reschedule
Recurring tasks (e.g., daily workout)	Do NOT skip; these compound. You can shift the time within the same day but never remove them.

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- If a one-time task gets bumped, just slide it to another day — it stays on the calendar
- If a recurring task gets bumped within a day, move it to a different time slot *that same day*
- "I still move things every day, every week" after nearly 20 years of doing this — it's fluid, not rigid
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🔑 Recap: The Six-Week Compression Formula 20:53

- **Step 1 — Compress time:** get super aggressive, attack each day
- **Step 2 — Make the plan:** pick exactly two goals — one income, one fitness — and design the plan so failure is impossible
- **Step 3 — Block responsibilities:** sleep, family, work/school, workouts go in first; everything else is optional
- **Step 4 — Fill white space:** use AI to plan out every remaining hour across the six weeks
- **Step 5 — Execute and adjust:** move one-time tasks as needed, protect recurring tasks, never delete anything
- Sacrifices required: missing games, concerts, parties, TV, doom scrolling — for six weeks
  - Brandon's framing: "If you sacrifice what you want now for what you want most later, you can have the things you sacrifice — but you can get a better version of it"
  - He now watches basketball courtside instead of on TV; he had to sacrifice TV first
- Current life at ~80 hours/week of work: still doesn't sacrifice sleep, still flies to another state every other weekend to spend time with his son, still maintains his relationship

> "If you can do this for the next 6 weeks, I promise you, you'll accomplish more than almost everyone you know."

- No dopamine detox or gimmicks required — just a full calendar and relentless execution